THE MASTERMIND COACHING CLASSES

CBSE / RBSE · Nursery – Class XII · Road No. 5, VKIA, Jaipur · 9887258679

CLASS VIII — SOCIAL SCIENCE · PRACTICE QUESTION PAPER

Mid-Term / Half-Yearly Examination · Session 2026–27 · Set 01

Class: 8	Subject: Social Science	Set 01	Time Allowed: 2 Hours 30 Minutes	Max. Marks: 60

GENERAL INSTRUCTIONS

1. All questions are compulsory.
2. The question paper is divided into six sections – A, B, C, D, E and F.
3. Section A contains Question No. 1 with 15 sub-parts, all Multiple Choice Questions. Each sub-part carries 1 mark. Choose the correct option.
4. Section B contains Question Nos. 2 to 5, which are very short answer questions carrying 2 marks each. Answer each question in at least 20 words.
5. Section C contains Question Nos. 6 and 7, which are short answer questions carrying 3 marks each. Answer each question in about 40–60 words.
6. Section D contains Question Nos. 8 and 9, which are long answer questions carrying 5 marks each. Answer each question in about 80–100 words.
7. Section E contains Question Nos. 10 to 13, which are source/case-based questions carrying 4 marks each (1+1+2). Read the given source carefully and answer the questions that follow.
8. Section F contains Question No. 14, a map-based question carrying 5 marks. Mark the given locations on the map using appropriate symbols/signs.
9. No overall choice has been provided in the question paper; however, internal choices are given in some questions. Attempt only one option in such questions.
10. For Visually Impaired students, a separate question has been provided in place of Question No. 14. It is to be attempted only by Visually Impaired students.
11. Maintain neatness and clarity while writing answers.

SECTION A — Multiple Choice Questions (1×15=15) — 15 marks

Question 1 · Choose the correct option for each sub-part.

1.(i) Tuna populations in the oceans have declined sharply mainly because of — **(1)**

(A) Excess rainfall over the oceans (B) The spread of coastal forests
(C) Over-fishing by commercial fleets (D) Use of solar energy by fishing boats

(ii) Arrange the following events in chronological order and select the correct option. **(1)**

1. Battle of Plassey
2. Foundation of the Delhi Sultanate
3. Coronation of Chhatrapati Shivaji at Raigad
4. Battle of Talikota

(A) 2, 4, 3, 1 (B) 4, 2, 3, 1 (C) 2, 3, 4, 1 (D) 2, 4, 1, 3

(iii) Which Delhi Sultan shifted the capital from Delhi to Daulatabad? **(1)**

(A) Ala-ud-din Khilji (B) Qutub-ud-din Aibak
(C) Ibrahim Lodi (D) Muhammad bin Tughlaq

(iv) Identify the correct match. **(1)**

(A) Battle of Haldighati – 1526 (B) Battle of Haldighati – 1576
(C) Battle of Haldighati – 1556 (D) Battle of Haldighati – 1599

(v) Which weapon did Chhatrapati Shivaji use to kill the Bijapur general Afzal Khan? **(1)**

(A) A long spear (B) Wagh nakh (tiger's claw)
(C) A bow and arrow (D) A cannon

(vi) Fill in the blank with the appropriate option. **(1)**

In the Maratha revenue system, an additional levy of 10 per cent over and above chauth was called .....

(A) Jizya (B) Mansab (C) Kharaj (D) Sardeshmukhi

(vii) The cartaz system, under which ships in the Arabian Sea had to buy permits or be seized, was introduced by the — **(1)**

(A) Portuguese (B) Dutch (C) French (D) English

(viii) Given below are two statements – Assertion (A) and Reason (R). Read them and select the correct option. **(1)**

Assertion (A): The Doctrine of Lapse became a tool for expanding British territory in India.
Reason (R): Under the Doctrine of Lapse, a princely state could be annexed if its ruler died without a natural male heir.

(A) A is correct, R is incorrect
(B) A is incorrect, R is correct
(C) Both A and R are correct and R is the correct explanation of A
(D) Both A and R are correct but R is not the correct explanation of A

(ix) Read Statement I and Statement II and select the correct option. **(1)**

Statement I: The Santhal Rebellion (1855–56) was led by the brothers Sidhu and Kanhu Murmu.
Statement II: The Indigo Revolt (1859–62) took place in the Chota Nagpur region.

(A) Only I is correct (B) Only II is correct
(C) Both are correct (D) Both are incorrect

(x) Universal adult franchise is provided under which Article of the Indian Constitution? **(1)**

(A) Article 21 (B) Article 324 (C) Article 326 (D) Article 356

(xi) In the First-Past-the-Post system, the winning candidate is the one who — **(1)**

(A) gets more than 50 per cent of the votes
(B) is nominated by the President
(C) belongs to the largest party in the Rajya Sabha
(D) gets the highest number of votes, even without a majority

(xii) A Money Bill can be introduced only in the — **(1)**

(A) Rajya Sabha (B) Supreme Court
(C) Lok Sabha (D) Either House as the Speaker decides

(xiii) The Council of Ministers at the Union level is collectively responsible to the — **(1)**

(A) Rajya Sabha (B) Lok Sabha
(C) Supreme Court (D) Election Commission

(xiv) A farmer buys a tractor for ploughing his fields. In terms of the factors of production, the tractor is part of his — **(1)**

(A) Capital (B) Land
(C) Labour (D) Entrepreneurship

(xv) The International Solar Alliance was launched in 2015 by India and — **(1)**

(A) France (B) Germany (C) Japan (D) Russia

SECTION B — Very Short Answer Questions (4×2=8) — 8 marks

Question Nos. 2 to 5 · each carries 2 marks · at least 20 words.

2.(A) Explain the term 'natural resource curse'. **(2)**

O R

2.(B) Distinguish between restoration and regeneration. **(2)**

3. State any two functions of the Election Commission of India. **(2)**

4.(A) What was the Doctrine of Lapse? Mention one result of this policy. **(2)**

OR

4.(B) Explain the Subsidiary Alliance in two points. **(2)**

5. Name any two sources from which a business can raise capital. **(2)**

SECTION C — Short Answer Questions (2×3=6) — 6 marks

Question Nos. 6 and 7 · each carries 3 marks · about 40–60 words.

6.(A) Explain any three features of the iqta system under the Delhi Sultanate. **(3)**

OR

6.(B) Explain any three features of the Mansabdari system of the Mughals. **(3)**

7.(A) Describe any three features of Shivaji's civil administration. **(3)**

OR

7.(B) Describe any three contributions of Ahilyabai Holkar. **(3)**

SECTION D — Long Answer Questions (2×5=10) — 10 marks

Question Nos. 8 and 9 · each carries 5 marks · about 80–100 words.

8.(A) Explain any five causes of the Great Rebellion of 1857. **(5)**

OR

8.(B) Explain any five ways in which British rule harmed the Indian economy. **(5)**

9. Describe five measures taken in India to ensure that universal adult franchise reaches every citizen. **(5)**

SECTION E — Case / Source Based Questions (4×4=16) — 16 marks

Question Nos. 10 to 13 · each carries 4 marks (1+1+2).

10. **Read the paragraph given below and answer the questions that follow: (1+1+2=4)**

> In the 1960s, farmers in Punjab shifted to high-yielding varieties of wheat and paddy. These crops need much more water than traditional seeds, and free electricity made it easy to pump groundwater day and night. Today the water table in large parts of the state has fallen beyond about 30 metres, and nearly four-fifths of its area is classified as 'over-exploited'. The state gained food security in the short run, but the soil and water now bear the cost.

Questions:

(10.1) Which new crop varieties increased the demand for water in Punjab? (1)

(10.2) What does the term 'over-exploited' mean in this passage? (1)

(10.3) Suggest any two measures to restore Punjab's groundwater. (2)

11. **Read the paragraph given below and answer the questions that follow: (1+1+2=4)**

> Shivaji's letters to his officers were specific. Teak needed for building ships of the navy could be cut, but only after permission. Mango and jackfruit trees, however, were not to be touched at all, because they take many years to mature and the villagers tend them as they would tend their own children. He warned that any gain made by oppressing others 'perishes soon, along with the oppressor'.

Questions:

(11.1) For what purpose could teak be cut, with permission? (1)

(11.2) Why were mango and jackfruit trees protected? (1)

(11.3) What does this instruction show about Shivaji's attitude towards his subjects and natural resources? (2)

12. Read the paragraph given below and answer the questions that follow: (1+1+2=4)

> In 1956, a serious train accident took place while Lal Bahadur Shastri was the Railway Minister. Although he was not personally blamed for it, Shastri felt that a minister must take moral responsibility for whatever happens in his ministry. Prime Minister Nehru at first declined his resignation, but Shastri insisted, and it was finally accepted.

Questions:

(12.1) Which ministry did Shastri head in 1956? (1)

(12.2) What kind of responsibility did Shastri accept by resigning? (1)

(12.3) How does this incident reflect accountability of the Executive in a parliamentary democracy? (2)

13. Read the paragraph given below and answer the questions that follow: (1+1+2=4)

> Indian cotton cloth — from ultra-thin muslins to richly embossed fabrics — was in great demand across the world. Under British rule, heavy duties were placed on Indian textiles entering Britain, while British cloth entered India with minimal tariffs. Thousands of weavers lost their livelihood. In 1834, the Governor-General William Bentinck observed that the bones of the cotton weavers were bleaching the plains of India.

Questions:

(13.1) Which Indian industry is described in the passage? (1)

(13.2) Who was the Governor-General of India in 1834? (1)

(13.3) How did British trade policy ruin this industry? (2)

SECTION F — Map Based Question (1×5=5) — 5 marks

Question No. 14 · 5 marks.

14. On the Political outline Map of India provided, locate and label any **five** of the following places using appropriate symbols/signs: (5×1=5) **(5)**

(I) Hampi
(II) Panipat
(III) Kudremukh iron ore mine
(IV) Digboi oil field
(V) Raniganj coal field
(VI) Raigad Fort

The following questions are for Visually Impaired students only, in lieu of Question No. 14. Answer any five questions:

(I) In which present-day Indian state/UT is Hampi located? 1
(II) In which present-day Indian state/UT is Panipat located? 1
(III) In which present-day Indian state/UT is Kudremukh iron ore mine located? 1
(IV) In which present-day Indian state/UT is Digboi oil field located? 1
(V) In which present-day Indian state/UT is Raniganj coal field located? 1
(VI) In which present-day Indian state/UT is Raigad Fort located? 1

